Xiangning (Shannon) Li

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human–AI Interaction · Human Agency & Trust · AI-Assisted Decision Making · Evidence-Grounded AI Agents

EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine — Paul Merage School of Business | Irvine, CA | 2025-2026
Master of Science in Business Analytics

Selected coursework: Statistics for Data Science; Social Analytics; Data and Programming Analytics; Machine Learning Analytics; Customer and Social Analytics; Deep Learning; Natural Language Processing.

Industry capstone (Cotality): Evidence-Informed Sales Engineering: Behavioral Analytics & Decision-Support Dashboard.

Middlesex University | London, UK | 2023 – 2024
Bachelor of Arts in Business Management (one-year top-up); First-Class Honours.

Shanghai Sibo Polytechnic College | Shanghai, China | 2015 – 2018
Associate Degree in Accounting.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

DealLens — Human–AI Decision Support for In-Progress Sales-Engineering Risk Sensemaking | 2026
Independent Researcher & System Developer | UC Irvine, Paul Merage School of Business
Faculty advisor: Luyi Gui, Associate Professor of Operations and Decision Technologies

- Independently designed and implemented an end-to-end research prototype combining Salesforce opportunity records and Gong conversations to study evolving evidence and risk across repeated professional interactions.
- Engineered opportunity-level data linkage and longitudinal features; benchmarked supervised models using grouped cross-validation, temporal holdouts, threshold optimization, and interpretable risk estimates.
- Built an interactive decision-support system integrating opportunity navigation, progressive risk monitoring, interaction-signal diagnostics, and evidence-linked next-action guidance.
- Demonstrated early-stage predictive utility across 1,868 labeled opportunities: identified 82.5% of eventual losses by Call 4 and 93.2% by Call 8, supporting earlier risk triage rather than waiting for late-stage outcomes.
- Connected interpretable ML signals to a grounded LLM interface that traces risk assessments to diagnostic evidence, supports iterative questioning, and enables users to examine, contest, and revise suggested actions.
- Prepared an HCI-oriented research manuscript for intended IUI 2027 poster submission; project work was featured in public UCI Merage and Cotality capstone coverage:
    - Cotality — https://linkedin.com/posts/cotality_businessanalytics-activity-7519498197845811200-afYi
    - UCI Merage — https://linkedin.com/posts/uci-paul-merage-school-of-business_businessanalytics-activity-7518733298622152704-1GeG

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

Li, X. “DealLens: Human–AI Decision Support for In-Progress Sales-Engineering Risk Sensemaking.” Manuscript in preparation; intended submission to IUI 2027 (poster track).

PROPOSED PHD RESEARCH

From Assistance to Authority — Calibrating AI Influence and Reciprocal Adaptation

- Investigate how AI advice, expressed confidence, and interaction roles change moment-level evidence evaluation, perceived epistemic authority, contestation, and decision ownership over repeated professional judgments.
- Distinguish durable human capability gains (including AI-off performance) from AI-system improvement through validated feedback; test when systems should request confirmation, targeted correction, or explanation while limiting human effort.

From Prediction to Intervention — Evidence-Grounded AI in Professional Workflows

- Examine how longitudinal evidence shifts can identify actionable intervention moments, and how AI should communicate risk, uncertainty, and supporting evidence in context rather than merely output predictions.

- Design and evaluate adaptive, workflow-aware intervention strategies using DealLens as a research testbed, measuring decision quality, intervention timing, verification effort, and professional agency.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Shenzhen Fankesi Technology Co., Ltd. — Global Business Development Manager | Beijing, China | May 2024 – Apr 2025
Analyzed European market feasibility and customer behavior; collaborated with technical colleagues on R/Python-based consumer segmentation and supported cross-border strategy.

Shenzhen Fankesi Technology Co., Ltd. — Marketing Specialist | Shenzhen, China | May 2021 – May 2023
Conducted market research, analyzed internal and external customer data, and coordinated evidence-informed product and content strategies.

HSBC Life Insurance Co., Ltd. — Personal Wealth Planner | Shenzhen, China | Dec 2020 – Apr 2021
Assessed client needs and financial portfolios; communicated personalized recommendations and maintained client relationships.

Chinasoft International Co., Ltd. — HRBP Administrative Support Specialist | Shanghai, China | Apr – Nov 2020
Supported HR operations and employee onboarding for a 500+ employee organization; coordinated employee engagement and operational records.

HSBC Bank (China) Co., Ltd. — Account Manager | Shanghai, China | Nov 2018 – Nov 2019
Led client outreach and market-development activities; recognized as a Top Sales Performer.

METHODS & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Machine Learning & Statistics: Classification & regression; logistic regression; tree-based models; ANOVA; hypothesis testing; confidence intervals; feature engineering; grouped/temporal validation; model calibration

AI/Agent Systems: LLM; RAG; prompt & context Engineering; Agentic workflow orchestration; evidence-grounded reasoning; Agent Memory; Human-in-the-Loop decision support

Research & Design Methods: Exploratory data analysis; quantitative study design; statistical inference; longitudinal analysis; research prototyping; dashboard design; web UX / interaction prototyping; data visualization

Programming & Tools: Python; R; SQL; pandas; NumPy; scikit-learn; PyTorch; Matplotlib; Seaborn; Jupyter; MongoDB; Apache Cassandra; SPSS; Salesforce; Gong